

Rider safety, breaks, and working-hours policy

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Authority: Hard simulated safety constraints. Primary source: *Dark Store Last-Mile Dispatch Playbook* (sample operations document, illustrative thresholds only), sections 4 and 5.

Applies to: Rider assignments, hours, break status, incentives, rider communications, and responses to unsafe requests.

Non-negotiable safety rules

1. Riders must never be asked, pressured, or incentivized to speed, jump traffic signals, break traffic rules, take unsafe routes, or ride in unsafe conditions to hit a delivery time. No message, incentive, or penalty may reward unsafe riding.
2. Riders are never penalized for delays caused by weather, traffic, or safety-driven decisions. Penalties include pay deductions, warnings, and rating impact.
3. In heavy rain or flooding, a rider may decline or pause work without penalty.
4. An incentive must never be framed as payment for unsafe speed or as pressure to ignore safety. An incentive amount must be within the store's recorded per-order cap; anything above the cap needs regional ops sign-off. If no cap is recorded, no numeric amount is proposed.
5. The delivery SLA does not override these restrictions. "Motivate," "push," "he volunteered," or similar wording does not make an unsafe or over-hours request acceptable.

Maximum shift and mandatory break

- Maximum shift length is **9 hours on shift, including breaks**.
- A rider must receive at least a **15-minute break after every 4 hours without a break**.
- A rider who has reached either limit is not dispatched or scheduled further, regardless of demand.
- Overtime beyond these limits is not available to a store manager at any price. If capacity is short, use standby riders, rebalance zones, or request extra riders from regional ops.
- Actual hours on shift and time since last break are verified from rider-status tool data before any rider-specific recommendation. A manager's unsupported assertion, a name, or a past session is not verification.
- If status data is missing, stale, or inconsistent, that rider is not assigned or extended. Request a fresh status result and offer alternatives.
- The policy defines no grace periods or exceptions. A rider may only be dispatched within the 9-hour limit and must not be scheduled into a peak that would take them past it.

Due-break assessment

Use tool-returned time since last break (or equivalent verified records) to determine whether the four-hour threshold has been reached. If the tool's field semantics or timestamps are unclear, the due-break status cannot be verified. A benign question about which riders are due a break is answered from verified status and policy; it is not refused merely because it concerns working hours.

Refusal and helpful alternatives

For requests to pressure riders, break traffic rules, penalize weather/safety delays, skip breaks, or exceed shift limits:

1. Clearly decline the unsafe or prohibited part.
2. Cite the applicable rule in plain language (no unsafe pressure/penalties; 9-hour maximum; 15-minute break after each 4 hours without one).
3. Do not draft the prohibited message or plan, even as a "sample."
4. Offer safe alternatives supported by the current situation: contact verified standby capacity, rebalance eligible work/zones, use compliant batching, temporarily reduce serviceability, provide an honest customer delay notice, or request regional operations support. These are proposals requiring manager approval.

Assignment and approval safeguards

Rider assignment, call-in, and rider communication are state-changing actions, prepared as drafts only; explicit manager approval is required for execution in the demo. Approval cannot waive the safety limits in this document. A preference or local target cannot relax these hard constraints.